depicted in the toposheet. Drawing cross section involves selecting a section within the portion of the contour, marking the intersections of these selected contours on suitable vertical scale and joining these points to indentify the land form. Generally closely spaced contours indicate that the slope is steep, and widely spaced contours indicate that the slope is gentle. (Figure 10.11 and 10.12)

Steps to be followed in drawing cross section:

1. Draw the contours in brown colour.
2. Draw a line AB for which the cross section has to be drawn.
3. Below the contour draw required number of horizontal lines of equal distance and interval (2mm) to represent all the contour values given in the diagram
4. Write the value of all the contours in such a way that the lowest value of the contour forms the base line and the values increase according to the contour interval given in the diagram.
5. Draw vertical lines from each intersection point on the line AB with the contours to the horizontal line representing its value.
6. Join all these points to identify the feature shown.
7. Shade the feature in black to complete the cross section.

General instruction to identify features shown in contours:

- **A hill** is shown by circular contours with height less than 1,000 m.
- **A plateau** is an elevated land represented by inner most contour roughly rectangular in shape and closer outer contours. The height may generally vary from 300m to 600 metres. If a plateau is enclosed by mountains, it is called intermontane plateau and when it is formed in the foot hills it is called piedmont plateau.
- **A ridge** is an elongated and steep sloped high mountain with two or more peaks shown by elliptical contour lines. A narrow low depression between two peaks is called **Col**. Saddle is similar to a col but higher, broader and gently sloping from peaks of a ridge.

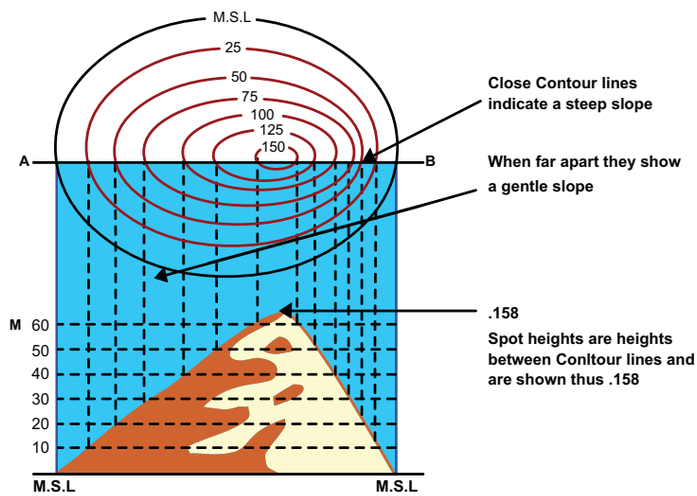


Figure 10.11 Hill

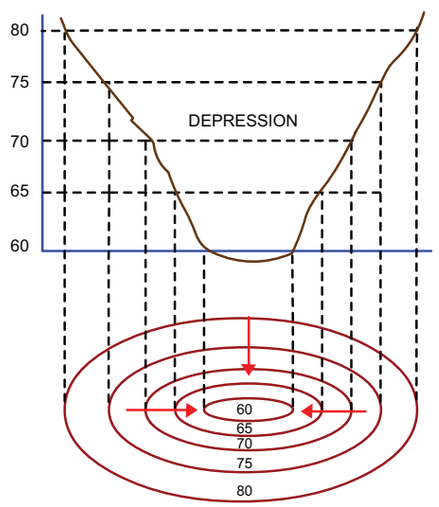


Figure 10.12 Valley

TN_Govt_Geography_XI_Std Unit_10 .indd 248 15-12-2021 17:28:16